

HIGH COST OF BEER

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I have to draw the attention of the authorities concerned and the general public to the anomalies in the supply and distribution of beer to Hoteliers by the Breweries in the country.

Whereas the Breweries have advertised their prices in the Papers which show that there has been no change in the pre-war price, hoteliers are not being given necessary opportunity to buy adequate stock from the Breweries directly.

As a consequence, the Hoteliers are forced by demand to buy from wholesale agents and stockists of the Breweries at cost 41/6d per carton (GOLDEN GUINEA AND STAR), but their registered agents sell to Hoteliers at 65/- per carton.

From the above it can be seen that the increase in the price of beer handed down to the marginal consumer in the Hotels is NOT of the making of Hoteliers. It therefore beats one to note that Hoteliers are being called names and subjected to

some disrespectful treatment because of the increase for which they should normally not be answerable.

I have made personal effort to get the authorities of the Breweries to look into this matter all to no avail. It behoves me therefore to demand as a matter of urgency a full-scale inquiry into the supply and distribution of beer to Hoteliers in Port Harcourt.

For my part, I am very prepared to come forward to give fuller details when called upon to do so.